



SENG 31242 – System Design Project

Persona 05

Interview Transcript

SithCare Channelling App

Group 10



Interview Transcript of Mental Health Patients – SithCare Channeling App

Date of Interview: 23/05/2026 (Saturday)

Location: Conducted remotely via Zoom

Interviewer: Project Member, SithCare Chanelling App

Interviewee: Persona 5, a 21-year-old, Psychology Undergraduate.

Interview Objective: To explore mental health patients' experiences and requirements for improved digital support.

Consent: The interviewee has consented to the interview being recorded and transcribed for internal documentation.

Source Link: [Persona 05 Interview](#)

Opening Statement

“Thank you for participating. We are developing a mental health support application to improve accessibility and support for patients. Your responses are confidential and will only be used for academic purposes. You may skip any question or stop at any point if uncomfortable. There are no right or wrong answers; we simply want to understand your experience.”

Section 1: Background Information (Ice Breaker)

Q1. Could you tell us a little about yourself? (Age range, occupation/student status, and anything you'd like to share about your lifestyle.)

Purpose: *Understand demographics and routines.*

Answer: I am a 21-year-old female currently pursuing my undergraduate degree, majoring in Psychology. I am not working at the moment because I am still in my first year. Regarding my daily lifestyle, I used to have many hobbies, but due to limited time now, I mainly listen to music and watch movies or dramas whenever I have free time. My hobbies have become limited because of my academic commitments.

Q2. Are you comfortable sharing your mental health diagnosis or concerns?

(Follow-up)

- When were you diagnosed?
- How did you realise something was wrong?



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- Who diagnosed you?

Purpose: Understand conditions.

Answer: I believe I was diagnosed in late 2023, during my A/L period. That year was particularly difficult because of study pressure, family pressure, and many other issues accumulated and eventually became overwhelming.

I realized something was wrong because my lifestyle had completely changed. I used to be energetic, outgoing, and someone who enjoyed spending time with friends and joking around. Suddenly, I lost motivation, stopped wanting to attend classes, and sometimes did not even want to get out of bed. Since I was interested in psychology, I watched mental health awareness content and started recognizing that my experiences were not normal.

Initially, I self-diagnosed based on my observations. Later, I sought professional help. I visited a psychotherapist for the first time to understand what I was experiencing. After several sessions, she recommended that I consult a psychiatrist, and then I started medication.

Q3. What symptoms or struggles do you experience because of your condition?

Answer: One of my first major symptoms was severe sleep problems. I could not sleep at night for months. Instead, I slept during the day and sometimes even during classes. My sleeping difficulties became so severe that my mother eventually noticed and became concerned.

I also experienced panic attacks, although I did not recognize them as panic attacks at the time. My appetite changed significantly; sometimes I would not eat at all, while other times I would overeat. Mentally, I struggled with overthinking, emotional numbness, a lack of feelings, and isolating myself from others.

Section 2: Current Mental Healthcare Experience

Q4. Can you describe your experience seeking mental health support?

Answer: Seeking mental health support in Sri Lanka was difficult because mental health services are not as openly accessible as physical healthcare. Finding professionals is difficult, and family acceptance also becomes an issue.

When I first told my mother that I thought I needed therapy, she was shocked and questioned why I would be depressed. Convincing family members that mental health treatment was necessary was one of the biggest challenges. In addition to that, finding a good therapist who is understanding and experienced was also difficult.



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Q5. What challenges do you face when booking appointments? (based on personal experience)

Answer: Cost was one of the biggest challenges because treatment expenses usually come from parents, which creates additional pressure to choose the right therapist carefully. There is always uncertainty about whether the therapist will genuinely help or worsen the situation.

I was fortunate because my family doctor recommended a psychotherapist. However, generally speaking, finding a suitable therapist or psychiatrist for mental health concerns is difficult due to limited availability.

Q6. Have you ever delayed seeking help? Why?

Answer: Yes. I delayed seeking help during my A/L period because I feared therapy or treatment would interfere with my studies and negatively impact my exams. Therefore, I postponed seeking support until after that period.

Q7. How comfortable are you discussing mental health openly?

Answer: I am generally open about mental health, especially because I study psychology. However, my comfort level depends on the environment. With family members, I am not very comfortable discussing my struggles and often keep conversations short.

At university, I am highly comfortable discussing mental health because it is part of our studies. With friends, I am comfortable with selected individuals. In workplace environments, I am less open and more selective.

Section 03: Technology Usage & Digital Behavior

Q8. Do you currently use any apps/websites related to mental health?

(Follow Up) What do you like/dislike about them?

Answer: Currently, I do not use any mental health applications, appointment booking apps, or counseling platforms because I am not actively continuing treatment or medication.

Q9. What frustrates you about existing healthcare or appointment systems? (Any improvements?)



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Answer: Currently, I do not use any mental health applications, appointment booking apps, or counseling platforms because I am not actively continuing treatment or medication.

Q10. If a mental health app existed, what would make you trust it?

Answer: Privacy and security would matter the most to me. I would only trust and use a mental health application if I were certain that my information was fully protected and would not be exposed.

Section 4: Therapist Matching (Aimed at therapist rec. Qs.)

Q11. When looking for a therapist, what information matters most?

Answer: Gender matters significantly to me because I personally feel more comfortable with female therapists. I have experienced both male and female therapists, and I would choose female therapists if given the option.

Apart from gender, specialization, experience, and personality also matter. It would be helpful if applications included personality descriptions because understanding a therapist's approach would help in choosing someone suitable.

Q12. What questions should an app ask before recommending a therapist?

Answer: I think therapist specialization, previous diagnoses, symptoms, and budget considerations should be included. Therapy costs are expensive, so financial capability is important when recommending professionals.

Section 5: Emergency & Crisis Situations

Q13. Have you experienced a mental health crisis? Only if comfortable

Answer: Yes. I have experienced severe depression, panic attacks, and emotional breakdowns multiple times. Although my depression improved over time, it never fully disappeared. Emotional breakdowns still occur, particularly during examination periods or emotionally stressful situations.

Q14. During emergencies, what support would help you most?



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Answer: I think 24/7 chat support or immediate call support would be extremely helpful during emergencies. If I experience a panic attack, immediate emotional support could make a significant difference.

If I cannot physically talk or move, chat support, emergency alerts, or location sharing would be beneficial.

Q15. Would you use emergency same-day booking? Why?

Answer: Yes, definitely. Mental health crises should be treated similarly to physical illnesses. If someone is experiencing emotional distress or breakdowns, they should be able to access help immediately rather than waiting.

Immediate access would also reduce delays because people often postpone seeking help once the crisis passes.

Section 6: Anonymous Community & Peer Support

Q16. Would anonymous support groups help you? Why?

Answer: I would say it depends. Anonymous support groups may be useful for less severe concerns, such as academic stress or general advice. However, when dealing with deeper emotional struggles, depression, trauma, or family issues, I would not feel comfortable sharing in anonymous groups.

Q17. What concerns would you have about anonymous communities?

Answer: My biggest concerns would be receiving incorrect advice, privacy breaches, and judgment. Since anonymous groups involve peers rather than professionals, there is always a risk of harmful guidance. I would also worry about personal information being leaked or misused.

Section 7: Privacy & Security (As mental health data is sensitive)

Q18. What privacy concerns would stop you from using a mental health app?

Answer: I would be concerned if personal details such as my name, age, or background information became visible to others. If profile information was exposed or not securely encrypted, I would avoid using the application.



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Q19. Would anonymity encourage you to seek support earlier?

Answer: For me personally, anonymity is not the main factor. I prefer knowing the person I am speaking with, understanding their personality, and trusting them before sharing my experiences.

However, in certain situations, such as general concerns or academic difficulties, anonymous support may still be useful.

Final Question (Ending)

Q20. Is there anything you wish healthcare providers or technology developers understood better about mental health patients?

Answer: I think both healthcare providers and technology developers need to understand that mental health patients are not machines. Emotions cannot always be categorized or explained clearly.

Healthcare providers often expect medication to solve everything quickly, but recovery is not that simple. Mental health struggles can last for years or even a lifetime. Patients need understanding, patience, and support rather than pressure to recover immediately.

Technology developers should design systems that recognize these complexities instead of oversimplifying mental health experiences.

Closing Statement

“Thank you for sharing your experiences. Your insights will help us design a more accessible and supportive mental health application for people who may face similar challenges.”